Colour frequency and phototherapy

Green light can recall **a forest**, **leaves** or a lamp on a writing desk. Let us say which of that is **atmosphere** and which is already **treatment**.

And it is exactly here that it is good to put **miraculous promises** aside. A green lamp is not a magic device for mood, concentration or chakras.

How it can work when it is “just light”

Light passes energy to substances that can absorb it. In the eye it triggers signals to the brain. In the skin it can trigger other biological processes. A photon is one small packet of this energy. **The colour does not say everything.** A weak green indicator light and a therapeutic device have very different parameters, that is spectrum, intensity and duration of exposure.

Where light is really studied

Winter depression

If your mood repeatedly worsens markedly in the dark months, you sleep a lot and ordinary things stop pleasing you, talk it over with a doctor or psychiatrist. For seasonal winter depression **strong white light** with UV filtered out is used, often in the morning. It helps influence the daily rhythm and in some people eases depressive symptoms. Distance and time are part of the treatment procedure, not instructions for using any lamp.

Skin

A dermatologist may recommend narrow-band UVB for psoriasis and some eczemas. That is invisible ultraviolet radiation that dampens the excessive activity of some immune cells in the skin. A green bulb does not replace this procedure.

Newborn jaundice

Special blue to blue-green light changes bilirubin in the skin into forms that the body can excrete more easily. A paediatrician decides on the need for treatment according to measurements and the child's condition. It is a concrete chemical effect of light, not the effect of a colour's mood.

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Migraine

In a migraine ordinary light can be unpleasant to painful. In experiments certain narrow-band green light worsened pain less than several other tested colours and in some people weak green light brought relief. A smaller preliminary study with green LEDs also recorded fewer days with headache, but it had limitations and is not enough on its own for a firm conclusion about treatment. **That does not mean green automatically calms everyone.**

When to ask about green light

If you have a diagnosed migraine and light makes your symptoms markedly worse, you can ask a neurologist about options for dealing with light sensitivity and whether it makes sense to try green light as a supplement to care. Keep a record of days with pain, intensity and conditions, otherwise it is hard to tell a real change.

Before buying, ask for the spectrum, intensity and clinical evidence of the particular device. A green screen or a decorative LED strip may not match the light that was studied. Do not stare at the source and do not carry on through pain or worsening vision.

A green picture and a green lamp

In painting you work with the experience and meaning of a colour. In phototherapy the bodily response to precisely described light is observed. Both experiences can have their place. Choose a treatment according to the difficulties you want to address.

A question for you

“In what light is it easy for me to slow down?”

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